

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ The yield on the 10-year Treasury note briefly touched a 24-year high before falling back and the S&P 500 and Nasdaq slipped from records, both shedding 0.2%. The Dow declined 0.7%. **A1, B1**

◆ Minutes of the Fed's last policy meeting suggest there will be a further interest-rate increase this year, but no urgency for action to be taken in October. **A2**

◆ France considered boosting its issuance of shorter-term debt as investors grow more hesitant to lend to the debt-laden country for longer periods. **A7**

◆ Three fired OpenAI employees called on the company to work with outside safety auditors and to preserve the ability to monitor increasingly sophisticated AI models. **B1**

◆ Canada's Weston family reached a deal to buy U.K. pharmacy chain Boots from Sycamore Partners for \$8.9 billion, including debt. **B3**

◆ Crypto firm Ripple has emerged as a serious player in providing swap financing to leveraged exchange-traded funds. **B1**

◆ Samsung forecast quarterly operating profit exceeding \$80 billion for the first time, as the world's largest memory-chip maker continues to cash in on the AI boom. **B3**

◆ Shell expects to report that its refining margin hit a record in the third quarter, driven by volatility stemming from the conflict in the Middle East. **B3**

◆ Porsche plans to make its cars even more exclusive while continuing to cut costs and streamline operations. **B2**

Worldwide

◆ A measles outbreak in Pennsylvania became the country's biggest since 1991 as declining vaccination rates make parts of the country vulnerable to infection. **A3**

◆ Tropical Storm Isaia formed in the warm waters off eastern Mexico and forecasters predicted that it would quickly strengthen into the first hurricane of the Atlantic season. **A3**

◆ A Tennessee judge ordered the state Department of Correction to preserve all evidence related to the botched execution of Christa Pike. **A4**

◆ Michigan Senate Republican nominee Mike Rogers broke with Trump over the trade war with Canada as he engages in a tight race against progressive Democrat Abdul El-Sayed. **A4**

◆ House Democratic leader Hakeem Jeffries said his party would move to reverse cuts to healthcare spending and bring down households' costs, expressing confidence Democrats would win control of the House. **A5**

◆ Henri Kagan and Kenso Soai were awarded the 2026 Nobel Prize in Chemistry for breakthroughs that have helped advance the development of modern pharmaceuticals. **A9**

◆ The FlyDubai first officer who allegedly tried to bring down Flight 1073 to Tel Aviv told investigators that he had nearly carried out an attack this past summer before reconsidering. **A8**

◆ Attacks claimed by Houthi militants damaged two airports in Saudi Arabia, killing three people. **A10**

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Israel Remembers the Victims of Oct. 7

PAINFUL MEMORIES: Israelis on Wednesday marked the third anniversary of the Hamas attack that left about 1,200 people dead. Benny and Maggy Solomon, whose daughter Hila was killed at the Nova music festival, attend a memorial at the site. **A9**

Tension, Turnover, Unmet Goals Bedevil Treasury Under Bessent

Midterms could turn on high prices and borrowing costs, pressuring secretary

WASHINGTON—Scott Bessent was fuming. President Trump had just asked his Treasury secretary to investigate allegations of fraud in Minnesota's Somali community—and Bessent thought one of his top deputies was dragging his feet. During a January meeting at the Treasury Department, Bessent confronted John Hurley, the agency's undersecretary for terrorism and financial intelligence, yelling at him and un-

leashing profanities. Bessent shouted so loudly that staff working nearby could hear him, according to people with direct knowledge of the matter. Weeks later, Bessent discussed with aides the idea of finding Hurley, who had been confirmed by the Senate for his position, a job outside the department, the people said. Hurley left to be U.S. ambassador to the Organization for Economic Cooperation and Development. It was one of a string of high-level departures in the top ranks of the department at a moment when the Treasury secretary was staring down the biggest challenges of his career. Bessent's behavior was a factor—

By Brian Schwartz, Josh Dawsey, Philip Wegmann and Gregory Zuckerman

and sometimes the most-important one—in the departure of multiple key officials, people familiar with the matter said. Bessent has dressed down senior advisers and junior staffers alike over issues large and small, according to more than a dozen current and former Treasury officials. But Trump has only pulled Bessent closer, empowering him to solve stubborn problems in the economy, including higher borrowing costs, intractable in-

flation pushed up by gas prices and government debt that is piling up quickly. At the same time, Bessent has been tasked with ending the war in Iran with a sweeping sanctions plan. A senior administration official said the president's entire economic policy agenda is on the Treasury secretary's shoulders. "Scott cannot fail," the official said. His backers say his hard-charging style gets results. But 20 months into his tenure at the department, Bessent is facing skepticism on Wall Street and an economy that could wreck Republican chances in November's midterm elections. Please turn to page A10

OpenAI Is Close on Anthropic's Heels Amid Price War

By ANGEL AU-YEUNG

Anthropic edged to the front of the AI race earlier this year with cutting-edge models and a coding tool that corporate America loved. By some measures, OpenAI is now hot on its heels. Demand for Anthropic's Claude Code was so strong in the spring that the company faced frequent outages and a computing crunch. But businesses grappling with mounting costs as more employees experimented with AI realized they didn't always need the most advanced options for most tasks. Companies, which now use a variety of models, increasingly turned to low-cost, open-weight models from China for some tasks. And some Claude users balked at guardrails the Anthropic put on its powerful Fable 5 model when it was released in early June. OpenAI stoked the price war this summer with the release of its GPT-5.6 lineup—Sol, Terra and Luna—giving customers access to models with varying capabilities, including some that are less expensive to run. Its Codex coding product and other business tools are now gaining ground, and it has Please turn to page A4

◆ Fired OpenAI workers seek monitor of AI models..... B1

SPORTS Moneyball killed the bunt. The Tampa Bay Rays are bringing it back. **A14**

BUSINESS & FINANCE Wells Fargo faces federal probe over efforts to boost Black homeownership. **B1**

The Latest Nuisance on Flights Is a Zoom Call at 30,000 Feet

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With in-flight internet improving, more fliers are taking work meetings and calling family

By ALISON SIDER

Christopher Mosby was pleased to find Starlink Wi-Fi available on his United Airlines flight from Chicago to Denver earlier this year. But 15 minutes into the trip, he heard the tell-tale sounds of a work call coming from seat 4A: agenda updates, awkward pauses and everyone's favorite: "Can you see my screen?" The new era of in-flight connectivity is here, and with it, a new era of in-flight annoyance. Fast, free internet is rolling

out on planes around the world, and travelers are finding it hard to resist the temptation to hop on a work Zoom or FaceTime a loved one—in some cases, like Mosby's flight, defying crew instructions that calls of any sort are forbidden. "I travel a lot, so having a connection that is fast enough to actually work from is great," said Mosby, who heads a cybersecurity company. "I just don't think the rest of the cabin needs to join your Teams meeting with you!" Please turn to page A12

Higher Rates Erode Value of Tech Stocks

By JACK PITCHER AND SAM GOLDFARB

Nvidia, the chip maker of the AI revolution, has played a starring role in the market's climb to record highs. But even its shares aren't commanding the premium they once did. Since January, the stock's valuation multiple, or the price that investors are willing to pay for each dollar of a company's earnings, has dropped significantly. It isn't alone. The S&P 500 has seen its multiple slide even as the

broad index has rumbled to new highs. Wall Street is blaming rising rates. The 10-year Treasury yield, which touched a new 24-year high on Wednesday, just posted its steepest quarterly increase since 1994. Aside from the chilling effect higher borrowing costs have on debt-dependent industries like real es- Please turn to page A5

◆ Fed minutes show no urgency for rate hike..... A2
◆ Surge in bond yields misses China..... B1

Influencers Urge Public: Don't Pay Medical Bills

By PETER LOFTUS

Ian Howard was shocked to get a \$1,000 bill for a brief visit to the emergency room that determined he sprained his ankle in a fall last year. Instead of fighting the bill, he just didn't pay it. "I went in for a sprained ankle. All's they did was look at it and say, the bitch is sprained" the 28-year-old yells in a rant on TikTok. "Y'all ain't never seeing that money!" The 24-second video has racked up more than 3 million views on TikTok and more than 8,000 comments, including stories about other hefty bills that have gone unpaid. The rancor against rising healthcare bills is exploding. Millions of people in the U.S.

are dropping Affordable Care Act plans after the end of subsidies, boosting the rolls of the uninsured. Even those with insurance are increasingly opting for high deductibles because costs for insurance premiums are so high. And coinsurance rules routinely require people to shell out even after they have hit their several-thousand-dollar deductibles. Howard said he posted about his ER bill because "I feel like most people probably relate as far as hospitals trying to upcharge an insane amount." Unpaid bills are a real pain point for hospitals. Patient debt and the cost of charity care rose 16% in the first half of the year, versus the year- Please turn to page A4